Table 16.1 summarises major conflict between Bangladesh and Myanmar over thirty-six years, between 1978 (the year of the first Rohingya exodus) and 2014. It indicates how, during and after the major incidents, the Bangladeshi authorities tried to solve the crises through bilateral meetings, first with their Myanmar counterparts and, only when those measures failed, by resorting to seeking international support. Also, unlike occasional digressions by their Myanmar counterparts, the Bangladeshi forces have not been reported for border violations or any such provocative incidents along the Myanmar borders.

Table 16.1. Major conflicts along the Myanmar–Bangladesh border (1978–2014)

Year	Trigger	Actions	Outcome
1977–79	Operation Nagamin launched in 1977; 200,000 Rohingyas forced across border into Bangladesh in 1978	Bilateral meetings Bangladesh/Myanmar. Appeal to international community for help	Almost all refugees repatriated in six phases (1978–79)
1991	Surprise attack by Myanmar Army on border at Cox's Bazar; another Rohingya exodus begins	3 Bangladesh soldiers killed; arms looted; Bangladesh side shows restraint	Major regional conflict averted
1992	A reported 250,000 Rohingyas enter Bangladesh from Myanmar to escape persecution	Calls for immediate action by international community	Only partial repatriation (inaction since 1996)
2008	Myanmar hires Daewoo to carry out gas exploration in the Bay of Bengal	Believing it to be its own waters, Bangladesh orders naval and military deployments	Tension until Daewoo withdraws, no escalation
2009	Bangladesh puts a case to the International Tribunal for the Law of the Sea in 2009 for maritime boundary demarcation with Myanmar	Myanmar reluctant, but attends tribunal; hearing takes place in September 2011	Tribunal declares verdict in 2012; accepted by both countries
2012	Series of conflicts between Rakhine Buddhists and Rohingya Muslims in northern Rakhine State	By October, Muslims of all ethnicities are targeted in various parts of Myanmar	90,000 Rohingya (Muslim) inhabitants displaced
2014 (Jan)	New wave of violence in Rakhine State	48 or more dead; international community concerned, but no action	No discernible outcome to date
2014 (May)	Myanmar Border Police shoots border patrol inside Bangladesh	One corporal dead; dead body taken inside Myanmar	Dead body returned; temporary tension at border